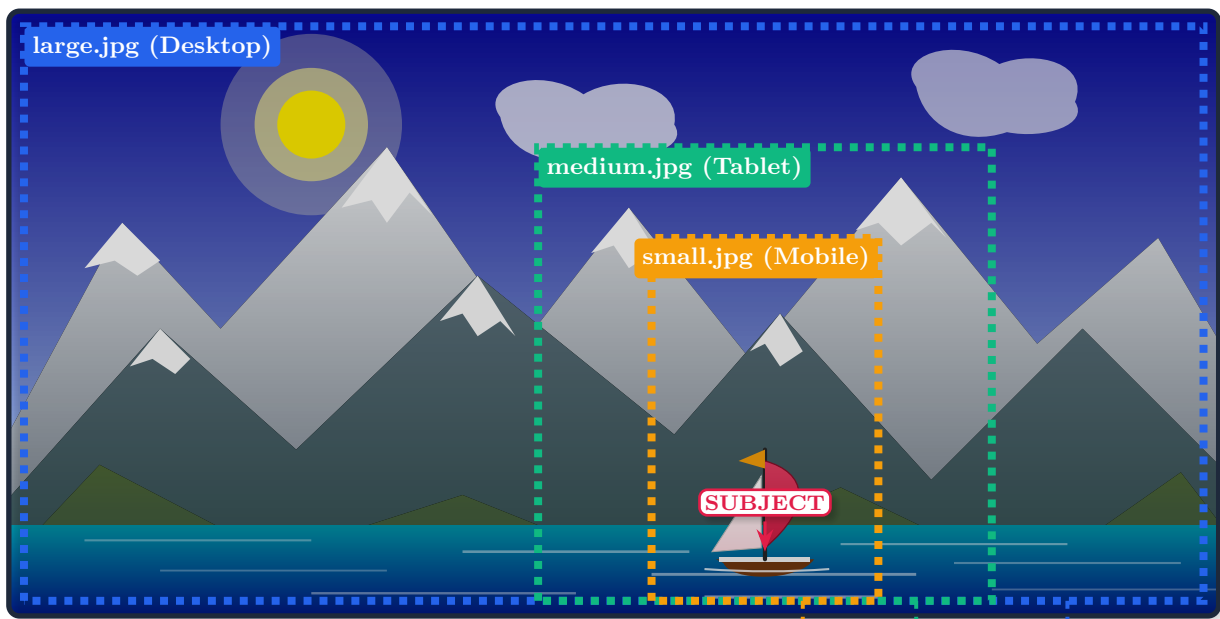


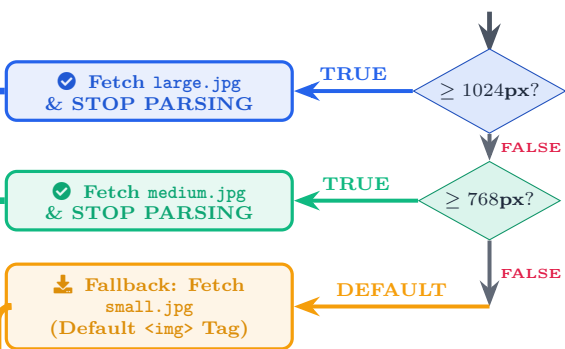
What is Art Direction?

Why simply scaling an image down is not always enough for flexible media.

Original Master Image (e.g., A sprawling landscape with a tiny subject)



Browser Evaluation Waterfall



```
index.html -- <picture> DOM Waterfall

<picture>

  <source media="(min-width: 1024px)" srcset="large.jpg">

  <source media="(min-width: 768px)" srcset="medium.jpg">

</picture>
```

The Resulting User Experience on Devices



Desktop / Laptop
Full landscape.
Subject provides context.



Tablet
Square crop.
Subject is prominent.



Mobile Phone
Portrait crop.
Subject fills the screen.

💡 The Power of the <picture> Tag

If we only used a single image and scaled it down with CSS (`max-width: 100%`), the subject on the mobile phone would be microscopic and unrecognizable. The `<picture>` tag allows us to serve entirely different image files (crops) based on viewport size, maintaining visual impact — this is **Art Direction**.